

E-tiGo Fleet Vehicle Management & Hire-to-Own Programme

Prepared for: E-tiGo Leadership
Date: 5 October 2026
Status: Proposal — awaiting business decisions
Version: 1.0

Table of Contents

- 1. [Overview](#)
- 2. [What Has Been Built](#)
- 3. [How the Fleet Flow Works Today](#)
- 4. [Hire-to-Own Programme \(Proposed\)](#)
- 5. [Driver Experience](#)
- 6. [Admin Experience](#)
- 7. [Business Decisions Required](#)
- 8. [Edge Cases & Risk Scenarios](#)
- 9. [Suggested Roadmap](#)

1. Overview

E-tiGo operates two categories of vehicles on the platform:

Category	Description	Plate Verification
Driver-owned	Driver brings their own vehicle	Required (via QoreID)
Fleet (company-owned)	E-tiGo owns the vehicle and assigns it to a driver	Skipped — E-tiGo already knows the vehicle

Fleet vehicles introduce a new business dimension: **Hire-to-Own** — drivers make daily payments toward eventual ownership of the vehicle they drive. Until the vehicle is fully paid off, it remains company property with associated rules and restrictions.

This document covers what is already built, how the Hire-to-Own model would work, and the business decisions needed before development continues.

2. What Has Been Built

The following is already implemented and tested:

- **is_fleet flag on vehicles** — Admin can mark any vehicle as fleet-owned via the dashboard
- **KYC flow adapts automatically** — Fleet vehicle drivers only need NIN + Driver's License verification (plate verification is skipped since the company already verified the vehicle)
- **Admin toggle endpoint** — `PATCH /admin/drivers/{id}/vehicle/fleet` marks or unmarks a vehicle as fleet
- **KYC status recalculation** — When a vehicle is toggled to fleet, the driver's KYC status is recalculated immediately. If NIN and license are already verified, the driver becomes KYC-verified without waiting for plate verification
- **Mobile API support** — The KYC status endpoint tells the mobile app which verifications are required vs optional, so the UI adapts for fleet drivers

What is NOT yet built (pending decisions below):

- Hire-to-Own payment tracking
 - Daily deduction logic
 - Vehicle reassignment workflow
 - Fleet vehicle pool/inventory management
 - Ownership transfer process
-

3. How the Fleet Flow Works Today

For a Driver Using a Fleet Vehicle

1. Driver registers on E-tiGo (same as any driver)
2. Admin assigns a fleet vehicle to the driver (or driver registers the vehicle and admin marks it as fleet)
3. Driver completes KYC:
 - ✓ NIN verification (required)
 - ✓ Driver's License verification (required)
 - ☐ Vehicle plate verification (skipped – fleet vehicle)
4. Admin reviews and approves the driver
5. Driver goes online and starts accepting rides

For an Admin

1. Admin registers a vehicle in the system
2. Admin marks the vehicle as fleet via the dashboard toggle
3. Admin assigns the vehicle to a driver
4. Admin can unmark a vehicle as fleet at any time (e.g., after ownership transfer is complete)

4. Hire-to-Own Programme (Proposed)

Concept

Fleet drivers make daily payments toward owning the vehicle they drive. This is common in ride-hailing across Nigeria and similar markets (e.g., Bolt fleet partners, MAX.ng hire-purchase).

Proposed Data Model

Each fleet vehicle would track:

Field	Description
Total vehicle price	Full purchase price of the vehicle
Daily payment amount	Fixed daily amount the driver pays
Payment start date	When the hire-to-own agreement started
Total paid to date	Running sum of all payments made
Expected completion date	Calculated from price ÷ daily amount
Ownership transferred	Whether the vehicle has been fully paid off
Agreement status	Active, paused, defaulted, completed, terminated

Payment Flow

Daily Cycle:

1. Driver earns fares throughout the day
2. At end-of-day (or configurable time), system calculates daily deduction
3. Deduction is taken from the driver's earnings balance
4. If earnings are insufficient → see "Shortfall Handling" in edge cases
5. Payment is recorded against the hire-to-own agreement
6. When `total_paid` $\geq$ `vehicle_price` → ownership transfer triggered

Ownership Transfer

When the driver completes all payments:

1. System marks the agreement as `completed`
2. Vehicle's `is_fleet` flag is set to `false` (now driver-owned)
3. Vehicle plate verification is triggered automatically
4. The driver's KYC status recalculates (now requires plate verification)
5. Admin is notified to process the physical ownership transfer (paperwork, registration)
6. Admin confirms the transfer in the dashboard

5. Driver Experience

Driver App — What Changes

Screen	Fleet Driver	Driver-Owned
KYC	NIN + License only	NIN + License + Plate
Vehicle details	Shows "Fleet Vehicle" badge	Normal
Earnings	Shows daily deduction line item	No deductions
Hire-to-Own tab	Progress bar, payment history, remaining balance	Not shown
Vehicle swap	May be possible (see decisions)	N/A

Daily Earnings Breakdown (Fleet Driver)

Today's Summary:

Gross earnings:	₦25,000
Platform commission:	-₦5,000 (20%)
Hire-to-Own deduction:	-₦3,500

Net payout:	₦16,500
-------------	---------

Hire-to-Own Progress:

 52%

₦780,000 of ₦1,500,000 paid

Est. completion: March 2027

6. Admin Experience

Admin Dashboard — Fleet Management

Feature	Description
Fleet inventory	List of all fleet vehicles, their assignment status, and hire-to-own progress
Assign vehicle	Assign an unassigned fleet vehicle to a driver
Unassign vehicle	Remove a vehicle from a driver (e.g., termination, swap)
Payment overview	Per-driver payment history, outstanding balance, missed payments
Mark ownership transferred	Complete the hire-to-own and convert to driver-owned
Defaulter list	Drivers with missed payments or low daily earnings
Reports	Fleet utilisation, revenue from hire-to-own, default rate

7. Business Decisions Required

The following questions must be answered before the Hire-to-Own feature can be built. Each question includes the options we see and our recommendation where applicable.

Q1: Daily Payment Amount — Fixed or Variable?

Option	Pros	Cons
Fixed daily amount (e.g., ₦3,500/day)	Simple, predictable for both parties	Driver may not earn enough on slow days
Percentage of daily earnings (e.g., 15%)	Adjusts to driver's actual income	Unpredictable completion timeline
Fixed with minimum earnings threshold	Balanced — only deducts when driver earns enough	Needs clear rules for shortfall

Our recommendation: Fixed daily amount with a minimum earnings threshold. This is the most common model in Nigerian fleet operations and gives drivers a clear target.

Q2: What Happens When a Driver's Daily Earnings Are Less Than the Deduction?

Option	Description
A. Carry forward	Shortfall rolls to the next day (driver owes ₦3,500 + ₦3,500 tomorrow)
B. Partial deduction	Deduct whatever is available, record the shortfall separately
C. Grace period	Allow X days of shortfall before consequences
D. Minimum earning days	Driver must drive at least X days per week; missed days don't accumulate debt

Our recommendation: Option B (partial deduction) with Option C (grace period). Deduct what's available, track the shortfall, and alert admin after X consecutive shortfall days.

Decision needed: How many consecutive shortfall days before the driver is flagged?

Suggested: 3 days → admin warning, 7 days → auto-pause account, 14 days → admin review for vehicle recovery.

Q3: Can a Fleet Driver Switch Vehicles?

Option	Description
No switching	Driver is locked to the assigned vehicle until ownership is complete or agreement is terminated
Admin-initiated swap	Admin can reassign a different fleet vehicle (e.g., if the current vehicle needs maintenance). Payment history transfers.
Payment resets on swap	If vehicle changes, the hire-to-own agreement resets

Our recommendation: Admin-initiated swap with payment history transferring (if vehicles are of equal value). If the new vehicle has a different price, the admin adjusts the agreement.

Q4: What Happens if the Hire-to-Own Agreement is Terminated Early?

Possible reasons: driver quits, driver defaults, vehicle is damaged/totalled, driver is suspended.

Scenario	Suggested Handling
Driver quits voluntarily	Vehicle returned, payments are forfeit (or partial refund — your call)
Driver defaults (too many missed payments)	Vehicle reclaimed after admin review, payments forfeit
Vehicle totalled/stolen	Insurance claim; agreement terminated; driver gets new vehicle or exits
Driver suspended for platform violation	Agreement paused; resumes if reinstated; terminated if permanent

Decision needed: - Are forfeited payments kept as a deposit/usage fee, or is there a partial refund? - What is the threshold for "too many missed payments" before termination?

Q5: Deduction Timing — When Does the Daily Cut Happen?

Option	Description
End of day (e.g., midnight)	Process all deductions at once
Per-trip	Take a percentage from each trip fare in real time
Manual / weekly	Driver pays manually or weekly settlement

Our recommendation: End-of-day batch processing. Simpler to implement, easier to audit, and drivers see a clean daily summary.

Decision needed: What time should the "day" reset? Midnight local time? Or a custom time like 4:00 AM (when ride activity is lowest)?

Q6: Should Fleet Drivers Have Different Commission Rates?

Since fleet drivers are effectively renting the vehicle from E-tiGo, should their platform commission rate differ from driver-owned vehicles?

Option	Description
Same commission	Fleet driver pays the same 20% commission + hire-to-own deduction
Reduced commission	Lower commission (e.g., 10%) since E-tiGo already earns from hire-to-own
Zero commission during hire-to-own	All platform revenue comes from the hire-to-own deduction

Decision needed: This significantly affects driver economics and retention.

Q7: Vehicle Price Transparency

Option	Description
Full transparency	Driver sees total price, daily rate, progress, expected completion date
Partial	Driver sees daily rate and progress but not the total vehicle price

Our recommendation: Full transparency. Nigerian consumer protection regulations and market trust favour this. It also reduces disputes.

Q8: What Happens After Ownership Transfer?

Once the driver fully pays off the vehicle:

Item	Decision Needed
Vehicle plate verification	Auto-triggered (already built) — but who handles the re-registration paperwork?
Commission rate	Does it change to the standard driver-owned rate?
Vehicle class	Does the vehicle keep its assigned class, or does the driver choose?
Physical transfer	Who handles DVLA re-registration? E-tiGo admin or driver?

Q9: Can a Driver Bring Their Own Vehicle AND Use a Fleet Vehicle?

Currently, each driver has one vehicle. If a fleet driver also owns a personal car:

Option	Description
One vehicle per driver (current)	Simple. Driver chooses one.
Multiple vehicles	Driver can switch between personal and fleet vehicle

Our recommendation: Keep one vehicle per driver for Phase 1. Multi-vehicle support adds significant complexity.

Q10: Fleet Vehicle Insurance & Maintenance

Item	Question
Insurance	Who pays? Included in the daily rate or separate?
Routine maintenance	E-tiGo covers it, or deducted from driver's balance?
Accident damage	Driver's responsibility, or shared? Deposit system?

These affect the daily rate calculation and the hire-to-own agreement terms.

8. Edge Cases & Risk Scenarios

Technical Edge Cases

Scenario	Risk	Mitigation
Driver goes offline for extended period (not driving)	No earnings to deduct, agreement stalls	Grace period + admin alerts + auto-pause after X days
Two drivers claim the same fleet vehicle	Data conflict	Enforce unique vehicle-to-driver assignment at DB level (already in place)
Vehicle is marked fleet while plate verification is in progress	Conflicting state	Cancel in-progress plate verification when vehicle is marked fleet
Admin unmarks fleet before hire-to-own is complete	Premature ownership status	Block unmark while hire-to-own agreement is active (unless terminated)
Driver deletes account mid-agreement	Orphaned agreement	Require agreement termination before account deletion
Daily deduction runs during a ride	Earnings change mid-deduction	Use atomic DB transactions; snapshot balance before deduction
Payment system is down at deduction time	Missed deduction	Retry queue with exponential backoff; reconcile next day

Business Risk Scenarios

Scenario	Risk	Mitigation
Driver stops driving but doesn't formally quit	Vehicle sits idle, no payments coming in	Inactivity detection: if driver doesn't complete a ride in X days, auto-notify admin
Driver earns well below daily rate consistently	Will never complete hire-to-own	Admin dashboard flags drivers below a minimum utilisation threshold
Vehicle depreciation exceeds payment timeline	Vehicle worth less than remaining balance	Set vehicle prices conservatively; factor in depreciation
Driver disputes deduction amounts	Trust issue	Full payment history visible in-app; itemised daily statements
Multiple drivers default simultaneously (economic downturn)	Fleet revenue drops	Admin reporting dashboard with early warning metrics
Driver transfers hire-to-own vehicle to another person informally	Liability and platform integrity	Enforce driver-vehicle binding; require admin involvement for any transfer

9. Suggested Roadmap

Phase 1 — Already Built (Current)

- [x] Fleet vehicle flag (`is_fleet`)
- [x] Admin can mark/unmark vehicles as fleet
- [x] KYC flow adapts — fleet vehicles skip plate verification
- [x] Mobile API returns `required` per verification type
- [x] KYC status recalculates automatically on fleet toggle

Phase 2 — Hire-to-Own Core (Estimated: 1–2 weeks after decisions)

- [] Hire-to-own agreement model (vehicle price, daily amount, start date, status)
- [] Admin: create hire-to-own agreement for a fleet driver
- [] Admin: view/edit/terminate agreement

- ☐ Daily deduction job (end-of-day batch)
- ☐ Shortfall tracking and grace period logic
- ☐ Driver app: hire-to-own progress screen
- ☐ Driver app: daily earnings breakdown with deduction line

Phase 3 — Operations & Reporting

- ☐ Admin: fleet inventory dashboard
- ☐ Admin: defaulter alerts and reports
- ☐ Admin: fleet utilisation reports
- ☐ Ownership transfer workflow (auto-trigger plate verification, unmark fleet)
- ☐ Driver inactivity detection

Phase 4 — Advanced

- ☐ Vehicle swap workflow
- ☐ Multi-tier pricing (different daily rates per vehicle model/value)
- ☐ Fleet partner support (third-party fleet owners)
- ☐ Automated agreement terms PDF generation

Next Steps

1. **Review this document** and discuss with the team
2. **Answer the 10 business questions** in Section 7 — these directly determine what we build
3. **Prioritise** which Phase 2 items to build first
4. We will update the technical plan and begin implementation once decisions are confirmed

This document is a living proposal. It will be updated as decisions are made and implementation progresses.